VistaIQ

VistaIQ: one view of everything going wrong

The problem

Most technology teams run half a dozen tools that watch their systems. One checks the code for security flaws. One watches the servers. One flags out-of-date components. One monitors the cloud bill and the cloud capacity. Each of these tools is good at its job, and each one has its own dashboard, its own login and its own way of describing a problem.

Nobody has a view across all of them.

The practical effect is that finding out how an application is doing means opening six tools and reading six different screens, then holding the answer together in your head. It does not scale. In a demonstration during our requirements call, a single application in a single security tool had well over a hundred open items waiting. Multiply that by six tools and by every application in the estate, and the honest position is that no one person knows the true state of anything.

Worse, the same underlying fault often shows up in several tools at once, and gets raised as several separate problems. Teams then fix the same thing three times, or fix the symptom in one place and miss it in another.

What VistaIQ does

VistaIQ sits above those tools and gives you one place to look.

It connects to each monitoring tool, collects everything they report, and reorganises it around the thing the business actually cares about, which is the application. Instead of asking 'what is my security tool saying today', you ask 'how is the customer portal doing', and you get one answer covering every tool at once.

Four things happen to each alert on the way in.

It gets **translated**. Every tool describes problems differently. VistaIQ converts them into one common format so they can sit side by side and be compared.

It gets **attached to the right thing**. A monitoring tool might say 'server ABC is struggling'. VistaIQ knows that server ABC runs your payments service, which is part of the customer portal, so the alert appears where a business person would expect to find it.

It gets **de-duplicated**. The same problem reported forty times becomes one entry with a count beside it, rather than forty things to read.

It gets **connected to related problems**. Where several alerts appear to share a root cause, VistaIQ groups them together and explains why it thinks so. This is the part that stops teams fixing the same fault repeatedly.

Once a group of related alerts is confirmed as a real problem, VistaIQ raises a single ticket in Jira for the development team, with everything they need to act on it. When the team fixes the issue and the original monitoring tool stops reporting it, VistaIQ notices, closes the alert and closes the ticket. No one has to remember to tidy up.

What you see

Two views cover most needs. An executive view showing every application in the estate, ranked by risk, so leadership can see at a glance where attention is needed. And an application view showing the detail for one application and the services beneath it.

What it deliberately does not do

VistaIQ does not fix anything, and it does not replace your monitoring tools. It is the layer that makes sense of what they are already telling you, and it hands the work to the team through the ticketing system they already use. Keeping that boundary clear is what keeps the product simple enough to be useful.

What we need from the business

Three things, and the project moves considerably faster with them settled early. A confirmed list of which monitoring tools are actually in use, since roughly half of those originally named are not yet in place. A map of your applications and the services within them, which is what lets VistaIQ put each alert in the right place. And a nominated owner per application, so problems have somewhere to go.